

# ENGLISH LANGUAGE (PAPER-I)

## Question 1

(Do not spend more than **30** minutes on this question.)

[20]

Write a composition (300 - 350 words) on **any one** of the following:

- (i) Write an original short story in which two children and their school teacher are the main characters.
- (ii) Imagine a situation where you get an opportunity to change **one** thing in your school. What would it be? Why do you want to change it? How would you bring about the change?
- (iii) *'School examinations do not test intelligence.'*

Express your views either for or against this statement.

- (iv) You are a regular visitor to your school library. Describe your library. Give details of the familiar sights. What do you see and feel as different students come in and check out the books? Why is this place so important?
- (v) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture, or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



## Comments of Examiners

- (i) Stories lacked creativity. Many candidates wrote a first-person narrative instead of a short story. Some candidates seemed to have lifted language and story elements from popular children's authors. A few candidates were unable to understand the meaning of 'original' in the given topic. Characters were inadequately developed. In some cases, the dialogues used had no role to play in carrying the story forward. In the essays of some candidates, the story lacked a neat ending. They were rambling or left incomplete.

Passages were 'lifted' from the comprehension, merely changing the names of the characters. Punctuation, spelling, grammatical and syntactical errors were made.

Short scripts and essays that by far exceeded the prescribed length were common. Paragraphs were not drawn.

- (ii) Common errors made by most of the candidates included:

- Misinterpretation of the topic. Instead of changing one thing about the school, candidates wrote about having to change the school.
- Instead of one specific change they would like to see, candidates wrote about their own behavioural changes, or listed several changes and did not then address the remainder of the question.
- The plan on how to bring about the change was largely missing.
- Essays often exceeded the word limit.

Some candidates wasted time in elaborate introductions.

A few candidates imagined they had to pose as the Principal of the school in order to implement the change. Impractical changes were suggested with little thought given to planning/implementation.

## Suggestions for teachers

- Discuss the 'format' of short story writing.
- Lay stress on the importance of writing an original story in every story writing practice session.
- Explain how to bring in a hint as to the theme, the main character/s and the setting in the introduction.
- Practice plot development and dialogue writing.
- Discuss character sketching as particular to the short story format.
- Give adequate practice of writing a logical or open-ended or cliffhanger endings through brainstorming sessions.
- Explain the difference between short story and narrative writing.
- Encourage narration of short stories in class to kindle students' imagination.
- Facilitate Group discussion in the class.
- Mind mapping on any given topic has to be taught and practiced in the class.
- Emphasize the importance of identifying highlights in a question.
- Specify in class that all the parts of the question must be addressed.
- Advise students to read the question carefully and to distinguish and differentiate between parts.
- Explore the common points between a descriptive and a narrative form.
- Encourage logical and linear pattern of thinking and presentation.
- Introduce the writing of rough drafts to help in planning.
- Focus on one change (or as the question demands) rather than writing more than one and straying from the question.
- Explain the importance of working within set word limits.

(iii) In the argumentative format, some candidates argued both sides of the question. They did not take a definitive stance. Logical reasoning to support their point of view was often missing. Repetitive arguments were common. These arguments in turn were not backed up by adequate illustration, analogy or example. Insufficient number of arguments were presented. The tone at times was aggrieved, rather than objective and persuasive.

(iv) This seemed to be the most popular choice. Even students with superior linguistic ability made the mistake of merely listing the ‘familiar sights’ – yellow walls, brown shelves, etc. The flow and weave of descriptions making the library that one quiet room in a building full of the hustle and bustle of noisy activity, was missing. What was ‘felt’ was not clearly brought out. The reactions of different candidates was not touched upon. Descriptions were not adequately vivid or evocative. ‘Why respecting the school library or developing reading as a habit is important’ was not brought into focus. Some candidates wrote about the benefits of reading without providing a description of the library. The candidates were not clear about the components of a descriptive essay.

(v) Most candidates started with ‘This picture shows us that...’ followed by a listing of the elements in the picture. A connection between the picture and the composition was lacking in most cases. The picture was not taken as the central theme or ‘title’ idea. A clear connection was missing in some cases. Poor linguistic ability and frequent grammatical errors compounded the problem. Few candidates were sometimes unable to form a composition and instead copied the question or comprehension passage. Colloquialisms, informal language, contractions, short forms were used.

### **Suggestions for teachers**

- Discuss the structure of an argumentative essay.
- Explain how to start with a ‘hook’, an interesting anecdote or idea.
- Stress upon the necessity of planning – to think of 3 to 4 main points to build the arguments around these points, using examples to illustrate and strengthen. Teach to avoid repetition.
- Stress upon the importance of a strong stance – either ‘for’ or ‘against’ and give practice in writing the same.
- Train students to conclude with an interesting idea or by summarising the argument or idea.
- Debates should be included in class in order to train the students to firmly state their view and take a clear stand.
- Explain the structure of descriptive essay writing.
- Discuss the difference between a simple listing and rich description.
- Discuss layers as for example in character sketch.
- Give sufficient exercises in picture composition by showing different pictures and videos to students and asking them to write compositions based on the picture.
- Discuss what the picture suggests/the core element and thereby arrive at the theme or central idea.
- Discuss how a story, a description or an account can be built on the picture.
- Discuss the varied possibilities of approaching a picture composition – as an account, a narrative, a story, or a description.
- Teach students how to avoid itemising the objects seen in the picture.

## MARKING SCHEME

### Question 1

|       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (i)   | The story must be original. All three characters should have a definite role.                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| (ii)  | Only <b>one</b> change required – what change.<br>Why necessary, benefits.<br>How - A plan on how to bring about the change is to be included.<br>E.g., Change in timing <u>or</u><br>Write a letter, take an opinion poll                                                                 |
| (iii) | Views either for or against are to be accepted. The candidate should take a clear stand and give valid reasons for whatever stand he / she takes.<br><br>Credit to be given for a cohesive well-constructed logical argument and ideas based on logical reasoning and personal experience. |
| (iv)  | Brief description of library, shelves, books, magazines, quiet, hush, librarian, students entering browsing, reading.<br><br>Importance of reading in a student's life.                                                                                                                    |
| (v)   | Accept a wide interpretation. Any relevant ideas taken from the picture should be accepted. However, a <i>mere itemization / listing / description</i> of the picture is to be penalized.                                                                                                  |

### Question 2

(Do not spend more than **20** minutes on this question.)

**[10]**

Select **any one** of the following:

- (i) You have had to shift to a new house recently. Write a letter to your grandmother telling her what you miss about your old house. Tell her also what you like about your new house and what you plan to do to make it comfortable for yourself.
- (ii) A certain book / chapter has been included in your syllabus. You have heard that a film version is now available. Write a letter to the Manager of a film theatre near your school, requesting that the film be shown. Tell him / her why it will be beneficial to the students.

## Comments of Examiners

- (i) **Format:** The address was incomplete, date was incorrect, or year was not given. Various incorrect combinations of dear grandfather/friend/parent were used in the salutation.

The comma was missing after salutation / subscription. In the subscription, many candidates wrote '*Yours faithfully, Yours truly, Your's lovingly, ABC*'. The surname was added to the first name in many cases. Mixed formats were used by some candidates.

**Content:** Some candidates did not analyse the question and wrote about what they missed about their old school instead of home. They also wrote about what they liked about themselves, their friends, the surroundings, new school instead of writing about their new home. Many candidates failed to mention what they missed about their old home or how they planned to make the new home comfortable. Points were jumbled up together. Often a single point was described in detail whereas the others were just mentioned.

**Expression:** Many candidates seemed to find it easier to write the letter than the composition. Some however copied the points from the topic instead of making an attempt to develop the points themselves.

- (ii) **Format:** Common errors made by candidates in this part were:

No 'to' address was given; or the designation and/or organization were missing from the address. Some candidates wrote the school name or XYZ. The date was incomplete or in numbers throughout. Instead of the examination date other dates were given (for example a date in March or April).

**Incorrect Salutation-** Many candidates did not use the word *Sir or Madam. Respected Sir/Madam or Ma'am...* was used by many candidates. In the Subscription: *Yours sincerely* was commonly used instead of *Yours faithfully or truly*. Sometimes *Yours affectionately* was used and the first name given without a surname. *Your's* was written with an apostrophe.

**Content:** Candidates frequently forgot to name the book or chapter. There was no specific show asked for. Why seeing the film would help the students was not explained. Some candidates wrote

## Suggestions for teachers

- Teach the correct format (address, date, salutation, and subscription).
- Drill students to read the question carefully to understand the points they need to elaborate upon. Students should be taught to develop the 'points' adequately.
- Conduct classroom activities to improve language, structure and expression. Emphasize on tone appropriate to content.
- Teach students the difference between formal and informal letter.
- Encourage reading and discussion to improve language dexterity.
- Clearly explain the key aspects of the letter like format, body and expression.
- Address adequately the importance of identifying key elements in a topic – the premise, the problems, the solutions, etc.
- Explain the necessity of using precise language such that specific information asked for or required by the letter is included.
- Ensure that students avoid flat faulty language, use of contractions, short forms, informal or colloquial language.
- Read out examples of good formal letters to give the students an understanding of how formal language may be employed effectively.
- Explain the difference between formal and informal language.
- Apart from grammar practice, encourage students to read to improve their language skills.

about the ‘fun’ element of going to watch a movie with friends from school rather than the learning experience.

**Expression:** Language as required in a formal letter was not used. Informal language and faulty sentence construction was common.

| MARKING SCHEME |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                              |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Question 2     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                              |
|                | <b>FRIENDLY LETTER:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>FORMAL LETTER:</b>                        |
|                | Address                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | From address                                 |
|                | Date                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Date                                         |
|                | Salutation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | To address                                   |
|                | X                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Salutation                                   |
|                | Subscription                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Subscription                                 |
|                | First name                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Name + surname/ <b>one</b> initial + surname |
| (i)            | <b>Format</b> (Friendly/Informal letter)<br><b>Content</b><br>What you miss -<br>e.g., Friends, locality, gardens, space, quiet ( <i>Any 2</i> )<br>What you like -<br>e.g., New, fresh, gardens, locality space, own room. ( <i>Any 2</i> )<br>What you plan to do -<br>e.g., Decorate, plant, paint ( <i>Any 1</i> )<br><b>Expression</b><br>Language, syntax, vocabulary |                                              |
| (ii)           | <b>Format</b> (Formal letter)<br><b>Content</b><br>Name of book / chapter.<br>e.g., Boy with Striped Pyjamas<br>Request to show - Please arrange/ show/have morning matinee / holiday.<br>Why beneficial to students -<br>e.g., Clearer understanding, come alive, depth etc.<br><b>Expression</b><br>Language, syntax, vocabulary                                          |                                              |



## Question 3

- (i) Write a notice to be put up in your school informing the pupils of Classes IX and X about the Remedial Classes to be held after the school hours and asking them to register their names for it. [5]
- (ii) Write an email to the Principal of a neighbouring school inviting their pupils to attend the classes if they so wish. Give all details of the classes to be held. [5]

## Comments of Examiners

- (i) In writing the notice, the following errors were observed:

- The creative title was missing.
- The candidates did not comprehend the meaning of the word ‘Remedial’ and misunderstood it to mean ‘Remedy’ and therefore wrote the creative heading as ‘First Aid’ or etc.
- Some candidates wrote ‘Interschool Remedial Competition’ or of it being held as part of the school’s golden jubilee celebration or thought it was associated with sports.
- Inappropriate / incorrect or a long title was given, e.g., Celebration of xyz school Remedial Classes/ Born to be Fit Forever.
- The notice details were given in a paragraph. Candidates did not adhere to the format.
- Date of the event was either too far ahead to be relevant or the same date of the examination was given as the date of the event, while the date of the event should have been at least 10 to 14 days after the notice. The date for registration was either too close to or even after the date of the event.
- Position of details was interchanged, details of time, date, venue were incomplete. For example, in the date, the year was not mentioned, the venue was not specific or just one part of the venue was written instead of both.

### Suggestions for teachers

- Explain why a creative title is needed and how to write a ‘phrasal’ title.
- Explain why the event needs to be clearly mentioned.
- Explain the necessity of giving the required information - date, venue (both ‘smaller’ and ‘larger’ locations) and time of the event correctly.
- Explain why the target audience/reader needs information regarding details such as where/with whom to register and by which date. Also point out why there should be a gap between this date and the date of the event.
- Make the students practice composing creative titles to go with common events/competitions such as singing, music, drawing, dancing, elocution, debate, sports, swimming, etc.
- Familiarise students with the elements of an official email id.
- Instruct students to copy the event name into the subject box.
- Explain why in the opening sentence, only the request/ invitation should be mentioned.
- Explain why details of the event need to be given in the email and why these should match with the notice details.
- Explain to the students the necessity of a polite closing of the mail.

(ii) In writing the email, the following errors were observed:

- Incorrect Email ids were given. The word 'Principal' was spelt 'principle' and no other letters etc. to distinguish it were inserted.
- Personal email ids were given.
- Subject was not written.
- The opening sentence was not clear and did not touch upon the topic.
- The closing sentence was missing in many cases. In many scripts, the opening and closing sentences overlapped with the content.
- Salutation and subscription: many candidates wrote 'Respected sir/ Ma'am' which is incorrect salutation or just 'thank you' and the name as subscription.
- In a few cases, date, venue, time were not mentioned. The date of the examination was written instead in the body of the mail. In some letters, the notice and email dates did not match.
- While the invitation was meant for pupils, some candidates invited the Principal of the neighbouring school to attend the Remedial classes.

### **Suggestions for teachers**

- Train students to write salutation and subscription as written in the formal letter.
- Show students an actual email, id etc. Explain to them the components of an email id – personal /particular name/etc. + @ + the provider.
- Clarify the difference between the role of the host and that of the invitee through demonstration or role play.

## **MARKING SCHEME**

### **Question 3**

|      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (i)  | <p>Creative Title – e.g., Ready to Learn, Refresh Revise, Relearn</p> <p>Event: Remedial Classes/Registration for Remedial Classes</p> <p>Date: e.g., 10 – 15 March 2023 (Accept single date or several dates)</p> <p>Time: e.g., 2.00 p.m. – 5.00 p.m. (after school hours)</p> <p>Venue: smaller place to larger</p> <p>Participate: All pupils who wish to avail of/ have been nominated for/etc. the remedial class/es should give their names to the Vice Principal/etc. on or before...</p> |
| (ii) | <p>E-mail – id</p> <p>Subject</p> <p>Salutation</p> <p>Opening sentence</p> <p>Closing sentence</p> <p>Subscription</p> <p>Expression – All details of the notice are to be included in the e-mail.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |



## Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

That huge bell never stopped ringing. It got us out of bed, it *summoned* us for meals, it rang between class periods, it sent us unwillingly to bed.

One morning it failed to ring, or rather, there was no bell to ring. Someone had removed it, and it wasn't found till late in the afternoon.

What a glorious day! As there was no bell to rouse us, everyone got up late, and there was no morning PT. Some of us missed breakfast too. The teachers got confused and mixed up their classes. How could the school manage without it? Confusion reigned.

Of course, no one owned up. It could have meant expulsion. Some suspicion fell on the Sports Captain because of our *aversion* to morning PT, but nothing could be proved.

10

No one was very anxious to find the bell – we were quite happy without it – but it was finally discovered hanging from a branch of one of the trees.

‘It may have been Mr. Sharma,’ surmised Brian. Mr. Sharma, our Maths teacher, was known to walk in his sleep. And sleepwalkers did funny things sometimes.

‘It could be Mool Chand himself,’ suggested Cyrus Satralkar.

Mool Chand was the school chowkidar, who also had the job of banging the brass bell at appointed times.

‘Why would he throw it away?’

20

‘He must be as fed up with ringing it as we are of hearing it.’ This was my theory. ‘Perhaps he wants a rise in salary.’

The identity of the culprit remained a mystery. Happily, the senior Hockey team went on a winning spree against all corners, and our month-end exits were *restored*.

But soon there was another sensation.

A girl was admitted to our class!

The boys were scandalized. No girl had ever studied in our school before. We

protested.

‘What’s the problem?’ asked Mr. Knight, our class master. ‘Haven’t you seen a girl before?’ 30

‘But – but. Sir...’ Tata was our spokesman. ‘How will we concentrate on our studies?’

‘When did you ever concentrate on your studies, Tata?’

‘Are we going co-ed, sir?’ Adams wanted to know.

‘Not at all,’ said Mr. Knight. ‘This is a special case. She is the school accounts manager’s daughter, and he can’t afford the Girls school fees. So, I’m sure you’ll make her feel very welcome.’

The accountant was a popular man who also ran the school’s tuck shop and allowed most of us a certain amount of credit. All our objections faded away. 40

At first, Sunita, our new entrant, was a bit of a distraction because, although she was very shy and demure, she had lovely curly hair, bright eyes, pink cheeks and a smile for everyone. All the boys were very polite and attentive to her and Brian in particular was always ready to help her.

– *Collection of Stories, Ruskin Bond*

- (i) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage) from the options provided: [3]

1. summoned (line 1)

- (a) totalled
- (b) ordered
- (c) requested
- (d) shout

2. aversion (line 10)

- (a) hatred
- (b) fear
- (c) politeness
- (d) creation

3. restored (line 25)

- (a) helped
- (b) returned
- (c) permit
- (d) victory

(ii) Answer the following questions briefly in your own words:

- (a) Why did no one confess to having removed the missing bell? [1]
- (b) Why did suspicion fall on the Sports Captain? [2]
- (c) What made Brian think that it was Mr. Sharma? [2]
- (d) Which sentence in the passage tells you that Mr. Knight thought poorly of Tata's academic performance? [2]
- (e) Why was the accountant a popular man? [2]

(iii) In not more than 50 words describe the effects of the lost bell. [8]

## Comments of Examiners

- (i) 1. Vocabulary: Several candidates interpreted the meanings without contextual reference. 'Summoned' was mistakenly identified as 'requested' by some from the MCQ. Candidates mistook summoned to be the sum total of something and wrote words outside the options provided as the meaning. Some candidates wrote the incorrect letter against the answer and vice-versa. A few candidates did not attempt all three answers.
2. 'aversion' was seen as 'politeness' by some, as 'fear' by many.
3. 'restored' was interpreted as 'victory'.
- (ii) (a) Many candidates wrote a general answer here – they were happy the bell had gone missing. Some missed the focus or 'fear of expulsion' point. Many wrote 'punishment' which word is not adequate as a substitute for 'expulsion'. Some candidates wrote

### Suggestions for teachers

- Encourage students to read the passage carefully and to note the meaning of the words as used in context.
- Point out how if the incorrect word is used or form of the word is used, it would not fit in the passage.
- Encourage students to practise vocabulary exercises and look up words in a dictionary on a regular basis.
- Teach students to read and make notes of words rich in meaning or connotation, similar sounding words, words with similar meanings.
- Adequate practice in MCQ format must be provided.
- Train students to identify the key aspects of a question.
- Students often do not understand the demand of the question. Understanding with reference should be taught.

about the advantages of not having a bell. They wrote at length on the thrill of finding the bell lost.

- (b) Most of the candidates answered this correctly. However, some missed out the word 'PT' and just wrote 'hatred for morning' thereby proving the answer incorrect.
  - (c) Most of the candidates answered this correctly. However, some interpreted the word 'funny' to mean comical rather than strange and mixed up the meaning slightly. Some candidates identified the word 'sleepwalker' but did not complete the thought or sentence.
  - (d) Those candidates who lost marks here either misquoted or left out the vital question mark at the end or wrote the answer in a paragraph. Several candidates quoted more than one sentence from the passage and did not highlight the correct sentence. Some candidates wrote the sentence in indirect speech.
  - (e) Majority of the candidates answered this correctly. Quite a few wrote 'tuck shop' as 'truck shop'.
- (iii) Several candidates did not keep to the word limit. They used more than 50 words to write the précis. Many candidates left out articles to reduce the word count. Some wrote the summary of the entire passage/ part of the passage. Grids were often not drawn and rough summaries not made. Word count was not given. Long-winded phrases and sentences were used where shorter, more precise wording would have been more effective.
- Some candidates were able to identify and write only 2 to 3 points. Chronological order was not followed. Some marks were lost for expression.
- Candidates focused more on use of the morning bell.

### **Suggestions for teachers**

- Give adequate practice to the students to use keywords from the given passage.
- Train students to infer the answer instead of lifting sentences from the passage.
- If one sentence needs to be quoted, the student must be trained to read to identify that particular sentence, and to then transfer/copy it verbatim to the answer script.
- Train the students to pick one appropriate sentence from the passage if a sentence has to be quoted from the passage.
- Students should be clearly told what quoting means. Students should be trained to highlight the most appropriate quote if he/she wishes to write more associated quotes.
- Teach students to comprehend the question and grasp which part of the passage needs to be included in the summary.
- Make the students practice writing the summary with the help of a grid.
- Teach the students to put together many points as a whole and leave out irrelevant details.
- Ensure that students follow the sequence of events as mentioned in the passage.
- Train the students to look for words or ideas that stand out - these could be naming or doing words - around which ideas have been built and then incorporate these words as main points into the summary.

## MARKING SCHEME

### Question 4

|       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (i)   | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. (b) ordered</li> <li>2. (a) hatred</li> <li>3. (b) returned</li> </ol>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| (ii)  | (a) Feared expulsion                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|       | (b) because of hatred for morning PT [+ nothing could be proved]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|       | (c) He walked in his sleep + sleepwalkers did funny things.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|       | (d) ‘When did you ever concentrate on your studies, Tata?’<br>To be quoted entirely<br>No marks to be given if written in own words, or partially quoted.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|       | (e) He ran the school tuck shop / allowed them credit.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| (iii) | <u>Points:</u> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. No bell to rouse</li> <li>2. Everyone got up late</li> <li>3. No morning PT</li> <li>4. Some of us missed breakfast</li> <li>5. Teachers got confused</li> <li>6. Mixed up classes [Full credit of just these 1<sup>st</sup> 6 given]</li> <li>7. Suspicion fell on the Sports Captain</li> <li>8. Speculation - it could have been Mr Sharma, Mool Chand... reasons</li> </ol> |

### Question 5

- (i) Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. [4]

#### Example:

(0) One night four college students \_\_\_\_\_ (be) out partying late and did not study for the test scheduled for the next day.

**Answer:** were

In the morning, they (1) \_\_\_\_\_ (think) of a plan. They (2) \_\_\_\_\_ (make) themselves look dirty with grease and dirt. Then they (3) \_\_\_\_\_ (go) to the Dean and (4) \_\_\_\_\_ (say) they (5) \_\_\_\_\_ (go) out to a wedding last night and on their way back the tyre of their car

burst and they had to push the car all the way back.

The Dean thought for a minute and said that they could have the re-test after three days. They (6) \_\_\_\_\_ (thank) him and said they would be ready. On the day of the test, they were made to sit in separate rooms. They agreed as they (7) \_\_\_\_\_ (prepare) well. But they (8) \_\_\_\_\_ (get) a rude shock!

(ii) Fill in the blanks with appropriate words. [4]

- (a) A bird \_\_\_\_\_ hand is worth two in the bush.
- (b) The boy is crazy \_\_\_\_\_ football.
- (c) She was tired \_\_\_\_\_ fighting and struggling all the time.
- (d) He opted \_\_\_\_\_ of the race.
- (e) We borrowed the bikes \_\_\_\_\_ our uncle.
- (f) The police station is \_\_\_\_\_ the right.
- (g) I looked at the stars \_\_\_\_\_ the telescope.
- (h) There was an accident \_\_\_\_\_ the crossroads.

(iii) Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence **without using** ***and, but*** or ***so***. Choose the correct option. [4]

1. He jumped up. He ran away.
  - (a) He jumped up before he ran away.
  - (b) Jumping up, he ran away.
  - (c) He ran away after jumping.
  - (d) He ran away because he jumped up.
2. He has failed many times. Still, he hopes to succeed.
  - (a) He succeeds after he failed many times.
  - (b) Despite of failing, he hopes to succeed.
  - (c) In spite of many failures, he hopes to succeed.
  - (d) He failed many times even though he hopes to succeed.
3. Do not be a jeweller. Do not be a goldsmith.
  - (a) Be neither a jeweller nor a goldsmith.
  - (b) Be both a jeweller and a goldsmith.
  - (c) Either be a jeweller or a goldsmith.



- (d) Be a jeweller as well as a goldsmith.
4. A cottager and his wife had a hen. The hen laid an egg every day.
- (a) Everyday, a hen laid an egg for a cottager and his wife.
- (b) A cottager and his wife had a hen who laid an egg every day.
- (c) The cottager and his wife had an egg every day because they had a hen.
- (d) A cottager and his wife had a hen which laid an egg every day.
- (iv) Re-write the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. Make other changes that may be necessary, but do not change the meaning of each sentence. Choose the correct options. **[8]**
1. He said to me, "I don't believe you."  
(Begin: *He said.....*)
- (a) He said he doesn't want to believe in me.
- (b) He said that he didn't believe me.
- (c) He said that he didn't believe in me.
- (d) He said I don't believe you.
2. Some boys were helping the wounded man.  
(Begin: *The wounded.....*)
- (a) The wounded man was helping some boys.
- (b) The wounded man were helping some boys.
- (c) The wounded man was being helped by some boys.
- (d) The wounded boys were helping the man.
3. He is as wise as Solomon.  
(Use: 'wiser')
- (a) Solomon was wiser than he is.
- (b) He and Solomon are wiser.
- (c) Solomon was the wisest.
- (d) Solomon was not wiser than he is.

4. If the boys do not reach the school on time, they will be punished.  
(Begin: Unless .....)
- (a) Unless the boys reach the school on time, they will not be punished.
  - (b) Unless the boys are punished, they will not reach the school on time.
  - (c) Unless the school punished the boys, they will not reach on time.
  - (d) Unless the boys reach the school on time, they will be punished.
5. As soon as he reaches home, his friends call him.  
(Begin: Hardly.....)
- (a) Hardly does he reach home when his friends call him.
  - (b) Hardly had he reached home than his friends called him.
  - (c) Hardly, he reaches home, his friends call him.
  - (d) Hardly when he reaches home than his friends call him.
6. She is weak, but she is courageous.  
(Begin: Despite.....)
- (a) Despite of being weak she is courageous.
  - (b) Despite being weak, she is courageous.
  - (c) Despite being courageous, she is not weak.
  - (d) Despite weak, she is courageous.
7. We will never forget what we saw.  
(Begin: Never.....)
- (a) Never forget what we see.
  - (b) Never will we forget what we had seen.
  - (c) Never will we see what we forget.
  - (d) Never will we forget what we saw.
8. Jaswant's grandfather is too old to take up this job.  
(Use: .....so.....that...)
- (a) Jaswant's grandfather is so old that he could not take up this job.

(b) Jaswant's grandfather is so old that he cannot take up this job.

(c) Jaswant's grandfather is so old that he could take up this job.

(d) Jaswant's grandfather is so old that he can take up this job.

## Comments of Examiners

(i) A number of candidates did not perform well in this part of the question. Some of the commonly occurring errors were as follows:

(1) 'thought' was written as 'thinked'

(5) 'went' was a common incorrect answer

(7) 'prepared' was a common incorrect answer

Children confused simple past with past perfect.

(ii) Common errors observed in the choice of prepositions were as follows:

(a) 'at' used instead of 'in'

(b) 'for' instead of 'about' – colloquial usage

(d) 'out of' – phrase written in full or 'from' instead of 'out'

(f) 'near' written instead of 'on' or 'to'

(g) 'from' used instead of 'through'

(h) 'towards', 'from' written instead of 'at' or 'near'

(iii) MCQ format for synthesis:

1. before and after concepts pulled into the sentence where not required.

2. mistakes made due to carelessness in reading, thinking 'despite of' is correct etc.

3. seems to indicate a lack of familiarity with 'either-or', 'neither-nor' terms.

4. The 'hen who' option used most frequently instead of 'which'.

## Suggestions for teachers

- Teach verb forms and tenses in detail and ensure students work out the verb form required logically themselves.
- Use a table to help the students see and understand the 'path' and conversion easily.
- If prepositions show relationships, demonstrate using teaching aids (and common everyday examples) how choosing the appropriate preposition is not difficult.
- Adverbs and phrasal verbs should be taken up in class.
- Explain the importance of reading the entire sentence before deciding upon the preposition.
- Teach the rules of synthesis of sentences.
- Regularly practice combining sentences without using 'and', 'but' or 'so'.
- Teach students to spot errors in sentences in order to choose the correct option.
- Teach students that two clauses are made mutually exclusive by the use of the subordinating conjunction 'though', 'although' etc and not inter-dependent as in a causal sentence.
- Train students to look for causal identifiers or 'mutually exclusive' clause hints.
- Teach when to use 'Neither-nor'; 'either-or'
- Have oral practice as a regular feature of the grammar class.

(iv) Common errors made by candidates in this part (in selecting from options in MCQ's) were:

1. Some candidates did not understand the conversion rules involved when changing from direct to reported speech. Mistakes were also made in choosing the tense of the sentence.
2. There was some confusion in who helped whom here.
3. The use of past tense with Solomon seemed to confuse many candidates.
4. Most candidates substituted 'will not be punished' for 'will be punished'.
5. Most candidates thought 'than' should be used instead of 'when' with 'Hardly...'.
6. Candidates chose 'Despite of'.
7. Most of the candidates chose the simple past tense instead of past perfect.
8. Many candidates chose 'could not' instead of 'cannot'.

### **Suggestions for teachers**

- Teach students Logical thinking.
- Revise the rules for transformation of sentences. These rules must be thoroughly understood along with the logic that goes into the forming of such rules.
- Reading of questions, instructions and options very carefully is imperative – teachers and facilitators must point this out.
- Adequate drill-exercise-practice must be given to ensure the students are comfortable with and can easily apply these rules to their day-to-day work. Provide adequate practice on Active and Passive Voice, Degrees of Comparison, Direct and Indirect Speech, use of the adverb 'too', 'Hardly-when', tense-change with transformation etc.
- Adequate practice in MCQ format must be provided.

## MARKING SCHEME

### Question 5

|       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (i)   | <p>[0.     were]</p> <p>1.     thought</p> <p>2.     made</p> <p>3.     went</p> <p>4.     said</p> <p>5.     had gone</p> <p>6.     thanked</p> <p>7.     had prepared</p> <p>8.     got</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| (ii)  | <p>(a)     in</p> <p>(b)     about</p> <p>(c)     of</p> <p>(d)     out</p> <p>(e)     from</p> <p>(f)     on/to</p> <p>(g)     through</p> <p>(h)     at/near</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| (iii) | <p>1. (b) Jumping up, he ran away.</p> <p>2. (c) In spite of many failures, he hopes to succeed.</p> <p>3. (a) Be neither a jeweller nor a goldsmith.</p> <p>4. (d) A cottager and his wife had a hen which laid an egg every day.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| (iv)  | <p>1. (b) He said that he didn't believe me.</p> <p>2. (c) The wounded man was being helped by some boys.</p> <p>3. (d) Solomon was not wiser than he is.</p> <p>4. (d) Unless the boys reach the school on time, they will be punished.</p> <p>5. (a) Hardly does he reach home when his friends call him.</p> <p>6. (b) Despite being weak, she is courageous.</p> <p>7. (b) Never will we forget what we had seen.</p> <p>8. (b) Jaswant's grandfather is so old that he cannot take up this job.</p> |

# GENERAL COMMENTS

Topics  
found  
difficult/  
confusing by  
candidates

## (a) Topics/ Concepts found Difficult

- Essay writing – Most candidates found it difficult to monitor the number of words – 300 to 350, it was either a short script or the essay exceeded the word limit. Students not well versed in the language copied the question or copied the entire passage given in Q4.
- Letter Writing – Most candidates could not comprehend the meaning of doing something to make oneself feel comfortable in a new home. In the informal letter, too many points were written for one part while the other/s may not have been touched upon at all. The formal letter saw inept or immature handling and understanding of basic information to be preferred or how to make specific requests. The language suitable for a formal letter has not been understood by many candidates.
- Notice Writing – The topic was not understood. The format was not written correctly by some candidates. The Notice was written in the form of a paragraph. The connection between the notice and email was not understood.
- Email – A few candidates could not frame an opening sentence that clearly stated the reason for writing the email. The connection between the notice and email was not understood.
- Comprehension – The vocabulary question posed a challenge for many candidates.
- Questions based on analysis/ understanding were not always understood by many candidates. Some of the answers in part (b) seemed to be incomplete or veering off in the wrong direction because the candidates were not familiar with certain terms. Most candidates found it a challenge to quote a sentence from the passage in answer iv). The Summary was understood and written quite well.
- Grammar – The question related to Prepositions was the most challenging.
- Lack of adequate practice was evident in the marks scored in the Grammar section. The rules of grammar were not clear to many candidates. It was clear that inadequate reading (as a habit) was a root cause for many of the errors.

## (b) Topics/Concepts between which candidates were confused

- Composition – the concept of change in part (ii) of Question 1.
- Letter – informal - the likes/dislikes etc. between the two homes; in the formal letter - candidates did not understand that writing 'a certain chapter' without giving a specific name or merely echoing the details given in the topic is inadequate.
- Notice-email – what remedial classes are and who the host is.
- Comprehension – vocabulary-oriented even in part b.
- Grammar – tenses, structure etc. In MCQs the candidates were confused by the distractors.



**Suggestions  
for  
candidates**

- Inculcate reading as a regular habit.
- Practise higher order thinking and analytical reasoning.
- Use logic and linear thinking patterns.
- Explore inclusive and wider reach in self-tutoring.
- Avoid use of short forms, abbreviations, colloquial language.
- Listen, absorb, read, and apply.
- Take the initiative to question teachers and clarify doubts.
- Consult dictionaries, the encyclopaedia and reference material.